GMRS Radio Cheat Sheet

General Radio Etiquette

1. Listen and wait for a pause in radio traffic before talking. (transmitting)
2. Hold down the push-to-talk (PTT) button and *wait 1 second* because your radio's transmitter may take that long to kick in.
    a. Hold down the PTT button firmly for as long as you are speaking.
    b. No one else can transmit while you are transmitting, so…
    c. Say one thing only each time you transmit. *Don't ramble*.
3. Say the name of who you're calling 2-3 times, and then your own.
4. When you are done, say "Over" to indicate the other side can talk.
5. To break into a conversation, say "Break" and your name during a pause.
    a. Say "Priority" if it's urgent, "Emergency" if it's an emergency.
6. Acknowledge the other side's transmission with "Copy" or "Roger".
7. When your conversation is over, say your name and then "Clear" to indicate that you're leaving the channel open for others to use.

NATO Phonetic Alphabet

Alfa	**E**cho	**I**ndia	**M**ike	**Q**uebec	**U**niform	**Y**ankee
Bravo	**F**oxtrot	**J**uliett	**N**ovember	**R**omeo	**V**ictor	**Z**ulu
Charlie	**G**olf	**K**ilo	**O**scar	**S**ierra	**W**hiskey	
Delta	**H**otel	**L**ima	**P**apa	**T**ango	**X**-Ray	

If You Can't Hear or Reach Others

1. Confirm you are on the right channel and privacy tone (if any).
2. Ensure the antenna isn't blocked by your body or anything else.
3. Move away from metal, concrete, earthen hills, etc.
4. Check that your battery has power and is seated correctly, the antenna is screwed in, the microphone and/or speaker aren't dirty or clogged, etc.
5. Check your settings: Volume, transmit power (you usually want the max), and squelch level (no signals will get through if it's set too high).
6. Move higher ("height is might") and try for line of sight with your contact.
7. Turn your radio off and on again.
8. Check your manual for information specific to your radio.

Getting Your License

Most GMRS users don't have a license. But you need one – and the callsign that comes with it – to get people to talk to you on repeaters. Get a 10-year license, for you and your whole family, by paying $35 on the FCC website. We recommend giving them a PO box, etc., rather than your home address.

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GMRS Channel Info		
Channel	**Range**	**Notes**
1-7	Medium	Good for general use
8-14	Shortest	Use when all other channels are busy
15-22	Longest	General use, simplex nets & *receiving* repeaters
23-30	Longest	Only *transmitting to* repeaters (if radio supported)
31+	N/A	Receiving only: AM/FM, NOAA weather, Ham, etc.

GMRS Frequencies

1 462.5625 MHz
2 462.5875 MHz
3 462.6125 MHz
4 462.6375 MHz
5 462.6625 MHz
6 462.6875 MHz
7 462.7125 MHz
8 467.5625 MHz
9 467.5875 MHz
10 467.6125 MHz
11 467.6375 MHz
12 467.6625 MHz
13 467.6875 MHz
14 467.7125 MHz
15 462.5500 MHz
16 462.5750 MHz
17 462.6000 MHz
18 462.6250 MHz
19 462.6500 MHz
20 462.6750 MHz
21 462.7000 MHz
22 462.7250 MHz

Emergency Frequencies to Listen To	
138.225MHz	FEMA channel for disaster relief operations
146.520MHz	National “calling” frequency for Ham radio
162.400 - 162.550MHz	NOAA weather channels; goes 162.400, 162.425, 162.45, 162.475, 162.500, 162.525, 162.550
163.4875	Emergency channel for the National Guard
168.550MHz	Federal civilian agency channel for emergencies/disasters

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